

PROJECT DOCUMENT

Note on Enclosed Materials

For Mayor Ito — meeting materials

v1.5 · 2026-09-24 · Rob Oudendijk

Mayor Ito,

The set of documents I am handing you today is a **draft** snapshot of where the project currently stands.

It includes a revised haiku — themed around walnuts, Mitsue, "75 years growing the forest," and new seeds for Mitsue's next generation.

Since we have this opportunity, I am also enclosing three documents summarizing the current state of the project. None of these are a sales pitch — they follow on from the trifold pamphlet I gave you earlier, when I mentioned I was working on this, and they show how the work connects to things you yourself have already said in council.

Enclosed Documents

1. Stakeholder Network Diagram (A4, 2 pages) A map of the relationships that already exist — landowners, the forest cooperative, Niwa Sawmill, Mitsue Kanko, the village office. It proposes no new organization and no new authority; it shows how the project builds on what is already there.

2. Collective Timeline Guide (A4, 4 pages) A text following the spirit of the village's own "100-Year Plan" manuscript, laid out in decades rather than quarters. The stated purpose is not money — it is completing what the generation that planted the cedar forests set out to do.

3. Forest-Led Model Diagram (A3, 1 page) A single-page summary of the whole concept. At its center: forest labor and reforestation advanced through the cooperative structure the village already has, with energy and the data center following from that — not the other way around.

Connection to What You Have Already Said

These materials are not a new idea we are bringing in — they follow directly from things you have said in council sessions:

- **December 2020 regular session:** on the forest management system, you stated that the village lacks enough receiving forestry operators and workers, and that the supply of willing landowners already exceeds the capacity to take them on. This names the real bottleneck as workforce capacity, not owner willingness or timber availability.
- **March 2021 policy address:** you noted that four 地域おこし協力隊 members were already training in self-managed forestry (自伐型林業) at the cooperative, and stated a policy of promoting the use of thinned wood at tourism facilities.
- **June 2026 regular session:** you confirmed that recruitment for the forestry 協力隊 position has drawn almost no applicants for two years running. In the same session, responding to Councilor Kageyama, you noted that the 地域活性化起業人 and 地域プロジェクトマネージャー programs were not abandoned, only unmatched with a company or personnel so far, with room to revive them if a workable case emerges.
- **December 2024 regular session:** you explained that after a clear-cut notification is filed, the village can only encourage replanting — there is no binding requirement. Related to this, I recently visited Tenkawa Village (2026-08-25) together with staff from more trees (NGO) to see an active reforestation site in person. Native broadleaf trees (including Kihada) are being planted on former ski-resort land, supported by a rotating group

of corporate sponsors, running continuously since 2021. I wanted to mention it as a real, working example of the kind of mechanism that could fill the gap you described in December 2024.

The three enclosed documents each start from one of these points: building a real receiving capacity for forestry labor, using thinned wood locally (tourism facilities, energy), and filling the reforestation gap that currently has no mechanism at all.

Concrete Steps Toward Attracting Labor

On the workforce shortage specifically, we are not only discussing it — we are actively working to bring people in:

- **Nara Institute of Science and Technology (NAIST):** a seminar on this project is **confirmed** for January 2027.
- **Nara Forester Academy:** a possible seminar is currently being discussed (via an introduction from Prof. Takuo Dome, Osaka University); we will keep you updated as this develops.

Both are concrete channels for connecting outside interest to Mitsue — directly addressing the shortage of receiving operators and workers you yourself identified.

We would welcome your continued guidance.

Biomass Energy & AI · Mitsue Village, Nara
Contact: Rob Oudendijk · oudendijk.biz@gmail.com · 080-2260-5966